

THE YEARS OF UPHEAVAL

INDIA TODAY's first decade is bracketed by tyranny and tragedy, with a lot of tumult in between. It's a period marked by the personality who ruled the country for nearly sixteen years altogether: a story of triumph and persistence—but also a cautionary tale. And a reminder that no political leader embodies this country's destiny or controls its narrative indefinitely.

The 1975-1985 story is also a tale of resilience. This was a time when India was tested in many ways. Its democratic fabric was uncomfortably stretched both by the Emergency and the farcical Janata coalition that followed. Its humanity questioned in the bloodshed and hatred that overtook the country from Punjab to Assam. Its ability to offer the most basic guarantees of safety to its citizens obscured in the deadly haze of gas that hung over Bhopal. And yet, as you will read, these were also years of triumph and of joy, with moments that many of us, whether at INDIA TODAY or elsewhere, look back at with pride and happiness.